SpeechGeek

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Corey Alderdice
Editor and Publisher

Stephanie Patterson
Publications Manager

959 Morgantown Rd., Apt. 3
Bowling Green, KY 42101
(270) 705-3632

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It is my pleasure to welcome you to the first issue of **SpeechGeek.com**. You may be asking why would we choose a URL as our title? The answer is quite simple. Our goal is to not only use this periodical as a means of furthering forensic performance, but to also create a paper and online environment that aids students at all forensic levels. We believe our material is top quality and ready to help you begin your journey toward becoming a champion. These scripts allow both students and coaches room to be expressive and add his or her own individual ideas. We believe you should be spending your time performing, not looking for quality material. We would love to hear your comments about our first issue. Best of luck as your season begins!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Canada, Eh!

by Frank and Jack Walston

NARR. We begin our story with a...story. (very spectacularish) A long time ago in a barren land filled with great wonder and delight, there lived a wee little man who loved everything around him. The trees, the earth, the cold, cold winters and everything aboot his home land. That's why you should come to Canada...because a wee little man told you to.

EXEC. Nice...I love that feeling of patriotism...yes...proud to be a Canadian. Ahem...so how did the commercial run with the test audiences?

ASST. Umm...sir...the only positive results we had were with chimpanzees and algae...

EXEC. WHY IS THAT?

ASST. Well sir it's just not appealing to any 'human' audience...

EXEC. What does this mean, eh?

ASST. Basically, primates and algae don't spend the dough so I guess the commercial is being pulled.

EXEC. We really have to do something here...I could lose my job...my car...my house...my flannel hat!!

ASST. Sir, I think I have an idea.

EXEC. Yes? Out with it.

ASST. Well while I am frequently watching American television I notice that their advertising campaigns are...well...entertaining...not boring...funny...intelligent...creative..

EXEC. I get the point. What are you saying?

ASST. (Whispers) Let's hire Americans to make our PR campaigns...that way we don't look so bad...

EXEC. OUI!!...I mean YES!! I love it. Lets get on the phone.

JOEL. Good afternoon ladies and gentlemen. On behalf of In Your Face Advertising, it is my pleasure to be here.

COREY. Thank you Joel. My name is Corey and you good people at the Canadian Ministry of Tourism have asked our firm to give your nation a public relations makeover.

JOEL. That's right. Here are the profit numbers from tourism last year. Zero (hold up a zero)

COREY. Fixable...definitely fixable

JOEL. Wait a minute. That's not right. (holds up negative one billion) Negative one billion...right.

COREY. Okay folks that's just bad-(bewildered look)

JOEL. Moving along, we have several ideas that will give your country a nice kick in the pants. So if you're ready, let's begin. We feel it's best to appeal to a new generation. It worked for Pepsi. It worked for Star Trek: The Next Generation. "N-E-X-T" Generation...see what I'm saying? Hmm...you know what I'm talking about.

COREY. You have to give kids what they want. They don't want their grandma's Canada. They want C-N-D wit duh triple A's mixed in...word.

JOEL. (aside) That means Canada.

COREY. Here's a little rap aboot a land called Canada. It's got lots of moose, but we ain't got pan-uh-das...

JOEL. (cuts off) That doesn't even make sense. What I think you were going for is, pandas?

COREY. Look I'm the one bustin' the lyrical rhymes YO! You stick to the beat ah-

The Amazing Presto

by Faith Codge

BETH. Ladies and Gentleman, prepare yourself for a feast of magical talent renowned the world over. Be ready to question what is real. To witness a power that some say comes from the other side. And above all, remember, don't trust your eyes... Tonight for all those assembled (looks at card) at the Glen Oaks Assisted Living Center. Please welcome, the one, the only...Amazing Presto!!!

MIKE. (appears drunk) Good evening fellow citizens. Would anyone in the audience care to lend me a twenty dollar bill. Not for a trick, but for my bus ride home. (no response) Okay...Uh... Hmm...I know you all have oxygen masks on, but take them off for a second and give a guy a break. (to Beth) Alright, let's move on to the big finale.

BETH. This next trick is for Mary Sawicky who is 97 years young today. Evoking shades of the late, great Harry Houdini, the Amazing Presto will now attempt to escape from not 2, but ONE straight jacket...While completely blindfolded and an apple in his mouth. (Beth prepares the apple, feeds him, puts him into straight jacket, inserts apple)
(He begins struggling)

BETH. Come on folks, bang those canes together and give him some encouragement. Not even Houdini could do this trick in 10 seconds....15 seconds...20...

MIKE. (with apple in mouth) Curtain. Curtain. (Spits out apple) Curtain!

(sitting in bar that night)

MIKE. Yeah. Give me a shot of Wise Men... and a double scotch neat....and...

BETH. ...a diet coke please. (awkward pause) Look, I think things are getting better. We're learning. I mean, the apple didn't work, so now we know. Next time we'll try a pear or an orange...or even a banana.

MIKE. Come on, Beth. I sucked. I saw those old folks pulling at the cords on their respirators halfway through the act. I couldn't even guess the card that old lady in the audience was holding.

BETH. Well...there's 52 cards in a deck. That could happen to anyone.

MIKE. Beth, every card in the deck is an ace of spades! (deep breath) I don't know. You'd think after 11 years of doing this, a man would get better.

BETH. (searching) Mike, you *are* the Amazing Presto. You've played all over the country. Souix Falls. Rapid City. Chattanooga. And I don't think I have to remind you of the time you shared the stage with a certain David Copperfield in Las Vegas. Actually I was in touch with him the other day. He swears that the straight jacket bit works better with a pear, not an apple.

MIKE. A pear? (a beat) When were you talking to Copperfield?

BETH. We've kept in touch a bit. Anyway, you played before thousands at that show and they loved you. *Everyone* loves you.

MIKE. That was a long time ago. Seven years. (a beat) I guess I was pretty good. (cheering up) You remember how much they clapped when I levitated you. Nobody was doing that then. I started that trend and it's my patented trick. I had you floating five feet in the air completely horizontal, busted out those hoops from virtually nowhere, passed you through them and...

BOTH. PRESTO!

MIKE. Okay. What's next? Here's the map. Where are we heading to now?

BETH. On Thursday we have Lacy's Bingo Parlor in Des Moines. Then we've got to truck it to the 8-Ball in Springfield. From there we are off to that high school reunion in Charlottesville. Big hall. Big venue.

MIKE. Alright, cool. Let's plan our route. If we hop onto I-80 and take it across to...(fades out)

BETH. He didn't have to map it out. I already had it planned. I'm not just his assistant. I'm also his tour manager. I book the shows, I plan the routes, I even budget for food...when there's any money to budget. Sometimes after a long show, I even provide him...(thinking of the right word)...comfort. (grins) It's a kind of lark, it's something to do. But it didn't take long for it to bite me...That *dream* of seeing OUR names in lights. THE AMAZING PRESTO with Beth. Kinda has a ring to it.

MIKE. (appears) Are you ready?

BETH. (snaps back) Yes. I figure we have about 300 miles before...

MIKE. Quit your yammering. Let's just go.

BETH. Bingo Players young and old. Mostly old. Put your hands together for the Amazing Presto Give him a warm welcome and he may just put that B-3 on your card when you need it the most. (starts applauding)

MIKE. For my first trick, folks, I will use the legendary hat of mystery,

BETH. Who knows what wonders this hat holds? Only the power of Presto can unleash its secrets.

MIKE. From the beginning of time, man has been spellbound by the majesty of flight. Men have given their lives to unravel the workings of this miracle and few have mastered this....(searching for the word to describe)

BETH. Cosmic riddle!

MIKE. From this hat, I summon the powers beyond to assemble and spring forth WITH FLIGHT!

BOTH. Presto! (nothing happens)

MIKE. Ha ha! Presto!

BETH. (a beat behind him) Presto! (pause) (looks into hat) Uh, Presto. It's dead.

MIKE. Well, you know ladies and gentlemen the powers of the unknown...

BETH. And the abyss can produce havoc...even with...the conjure of those...

MIKE. Oh, geeze. Come on. Beth! That pigeon cost 30 dollars. Sales guy said they are supposed to live 6 years...Minimum! (a beat) You know what? I got a magic trick for you, pigeon. (flicks off the dead bird). (Leaves stage)

BETH. Take five, folks.

MIKE. Yeah. Give me a shot of Wise Men... and a double scotch neat....and...

BETH. Mike. We're at a truck stop.

MIKE. I'll take a coffee.

BETH. ...and a water. So, do you think we should replace the hat of mystery tonight?

MIKE. I don't give a shit. Whatever you want to call it. The sweatshirt of marvel...the earrings of majesty...Whatever.

BETH. Presentation is everything. Dave says the same thing. Some of his tricks aren't even that hard, he just...

MIKE. His tricks aren't that hard??!! Dude made the Statue of Liberty disappear! And he's married to a model! Hello???!!! You hand me a can of

WD-40 and I couldn't make a squeak disappear. And all I have is you! (long beat) (he realizes what he said) So, when did you become best friends with Dave anyway?

BETH. Why are you acting like this? We write letters back and forth...occasionally. What's the big deal? You and I are a team.

MIKE. Team my ass. Team of 3. Me, you and David Crap-erfield. Stop putting me up to *that guy*. Every time it's "Dave does this, Dave does that." What-

BETH. He wants me to join him in Vegas!!! (long pause)

MIKE. What?

BETH. He's been writing me for about a year. He has a team of assistants and he wants me to come be a part of that.

MIKE. So, what's stopping you?

BETH. What do you mean? Mike, you're the Amazing Presto...with Beth. We do this together. Eleven years is what's stopping me. We write and I steal some tips from him, but that's all. I don't want to do this with anyone but you.

BETH. Welcome class of '64. (Mike is pacing in the background, checking his watch, looks very bored) You've watched on television as the greats have levitated dogs, cats and even a rooster. But tonight, the Amazing Presto will lift ME, FIVE FEET IN THE AIR, using nothing more than the force of his own mind. So, without further ado, the Breathtaking, Mind Boggling, Amazing Presto!!!

MIKE. Yeah yeah, thank you. Let's just get to the trick. Beth, if you will.
(She moves to her position and the stage is all his)
(begins trying to move her. No luck. Tries again. No luck. Heckling begins)

BETH. (from behind as audience member) Come on. Get off the stage! (appears as Beth) He needs some encouragement folks! (He tries again. Nothing) (heckling) Why don't you try levitating your ass off the stage, buddy?!(He tries again. Nothing) (He gets very irritated) (heckling) Go walk into oncomin' traffic you Copperfield wannabe!!

MIKE. (to audience) SHUT UP!!!!! (leaves)

BETH. (left alone on stage) (shocked) Ladies and Gentlemen, the Amazing Presto needs just a few minutes. (pause) Come on, people, he's a great magician. You are in the presence of a magical genius. Don't leave. Pay attention! Where are you all going? Give the guy a chance. Please. He is the Amazing Presto!!

BETH. What happened out there? You almost had me. I could feel my feet leaving the ground. Why'd you leave?

MIKE. (pacing, but calm) It's okay. I think we're just wasting time on these retired tricks. No sense trying to recapture the past.

BETH. Mike, what do you –

MIKE. Look, Beth. I've been thinking and there is this new trick that I think will set everything right. It's perfect for us. It's an oldie, but a goodie. The trick takes two people, one of whom is a beautiful, talented and promising woman. The other is a man who realizes too late that he chose the wrong dream. The stage is quiet. The audience is hushed. The magician waves his hand and disappears completely.

BETH. And the woman?

MIKE. She makes a choice to not turn around and not follow him. Then she can do all the things she deserves to do.

BETH. Mike-

MIKE. Do this with me, Beth. Please. Turn around. Count to three and Presto. (leaves)

BETH. One....Presto.